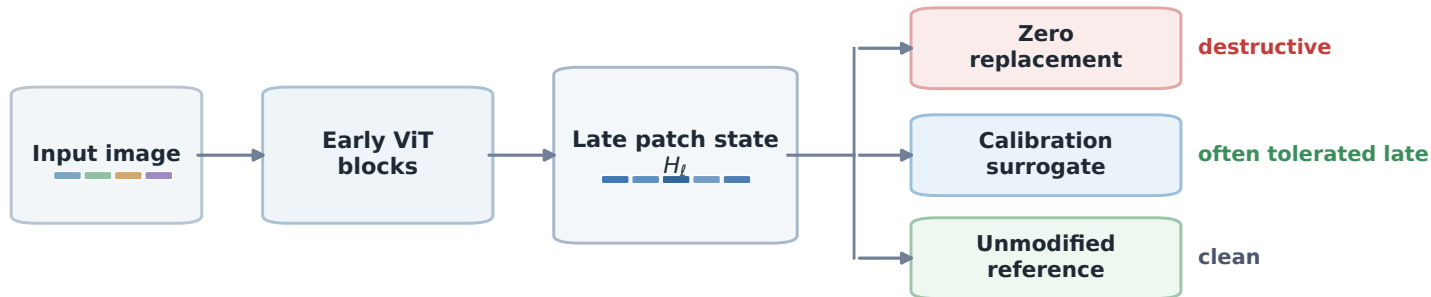


(a) Activation substitution isolates what late patch states must preserve



Upstream image processing is unchanged; [CLS], token slots, sequence length, model weights, and downstream blocks remain fixed.

(b) Geometry



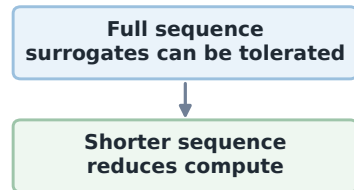
Correct scale is insufficient:
feature coordinates and orientation matter.

(c) Diversity



At complete replacement, token-to-token
variation remains functionally important.

(d) Boundary



but

matched pruning $\geq$ synthetic carrier